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Three things veteran
planetary health
investors look for in a
startup



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Over the years, the pair have developed a rubric that helps them decide where to place their fund's money.

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"We really want to have some sense that they're building something that people actually want to buy," Teamey said. "A common mistake among entrepreneurs is the 'if you build it they will come' mentality."

Lastly, Teamey and O'Brien look for companies that efficiently use the money they have. "How fast can you graduate from venture capital?" O'Brien said.

For many investors, the answer to those questions is usually “software,” though it doesn’t always have to be. “There’s a lot of things that are different,” Teamey said, though he adds that one common misconception — that deep tech startups aren’t capital efficient — doesn’t add up.

“Capital efficiency can actually be somewhat analogous [to software], but the capital intensity is often very different,” he said.

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are those adoption barriers, and then what companies can overcome those adoption barriers,” O’Brien said. “It also helps us inform what are the average time-to-markets.”

That detail is top of mind for the team as they navigate the current downturn in the market. “This won’t be the first time or the last time there will be a



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cycle,” O’Brien said. “It’s not always going to be like rocket ships.”

“There’s pluses and minuses of every part of the cycle,” Teamey added. “If you can figure it out now, you’re going to crush it as the markets get better.”

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DCVC wanted to raise \$500M for its first climate fund, but the market had other plans

Rebecca Szkutak — 2:45 PM PDT · April 3, 2024



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for Square, AngelList, Uber and for his annual “Deep Tech in Davos” event. As part of the Davos event in February, Bogue called out AI applications for

climate technologies as one of the “major opportunities” for DCVC, alongside tech bio and robotics.

This climate fund is targeting climate startups at the mid-stages where the firm thinks the climate startup ecosystem is currently underfunded, according to materials from a recent New Mexico State Investment Council meeting where the GP presented. Although this is DCVC’s first climate

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fundraising as well. Climate-focused VC funds have raised more than \$710 million so far in 2024, according to data from Preqin, on track to match or surpass last year's \$2.17 billion raised and not far off 2022's record of \$2.9 billion.

While both LPs and analysts have told TechCrunch that they aren't expecting 2024 to be a significantly better year for VC fundraising — some think it might be worse than 2023 — for DCVC's new climate fund, things r
than its

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Juniper Ventures spins out of Climate Capital to invest in synthetic biology for the climate



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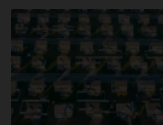
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CLIMATE



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Tim De Chant - Aug 1, 2025

investments before raising the new fund, Kan told TechCrunch.

Initially, Juniper started life as Climate Capital Bio, investing in synthetic biology startups that focus on climate. But “as we kind of got further down the path, we realized what we should lean into is the fact that we can be the climate biotech people,” Luciani said. “Climate Capital is a great brand, but it’s really a brand as a generalist, and that’s quite different

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Juniper operates as a normal venture fund, writing checks between \$100,000 and \$500,000 to scientists who are working to commercialize their research. The goal, Kan said, is “to be the first institutional investor, to help them think through how to build a company.”

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Tim De Chant

Senior Reporter, Climate |   in

Tim De Chant is a senior climate reporter at TechCrunch. He has written for a wide range of publications, including...

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